FITTEST APP

Strength & Hypertrophy Training Guide

1. Principles of Strength & Hypertrophy

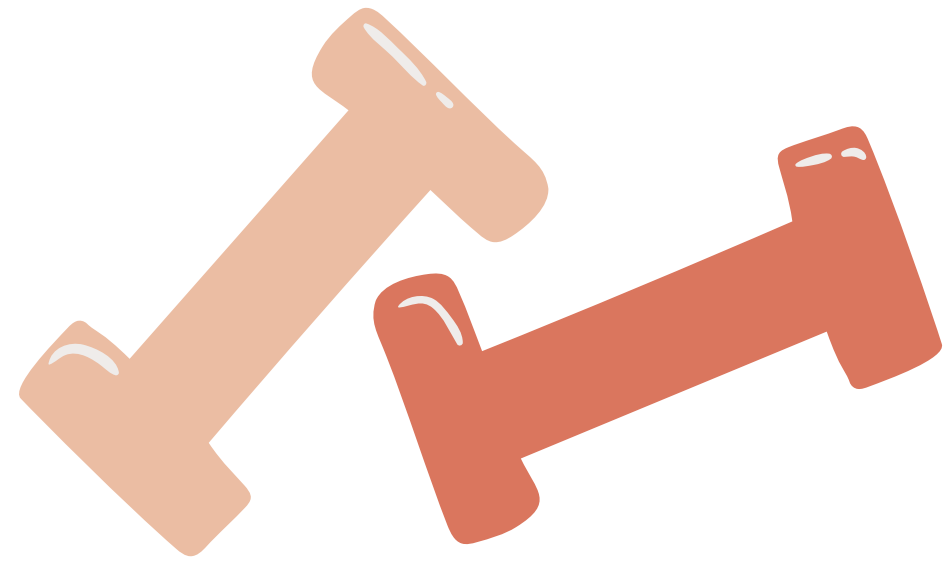
To build muscle (hypertrophy) and strength, you need to focus on these key factors:

- **Progressive Overload** – Gradually increase weight, reps, or intensity over time.
- **Volume & Intensity** – Aim for 10-20 sets per muscle group per week, keeping reps in the 5-12 range.
- **Rest & Recovery** – Muscles grow outside the gym; prioritize sleep and nutrition.
- **Consistency** – Results take time; showing up and staying disciplined is key.
- **Proper Nutrition** – Protein intake, carbohydrates, and fats all play a role in muscle growth.

2. Choosing the Right Training Split

Your workout split should match your experience level, schedule, and recovery ability. Here are three effective splits:

- **Full-Body (3x per week)** – Best for beginners or those with limited time.
- **Upper/Lower (4x per week)** – Great for balancing strength and hypertrophy.
- **Push/Pull/Legs (5-6x per week)** – Ideal for maximizing volume and specialization.



2.1 How to Optimize Your Split:

- **Rest Days Matter** – Give muscles at least 48 hours to recover before training them again.
- **Listen to Your Body** – If you're constantly sore or fatigued, adjust volume or frequency.
- **Track Progress** – Keep a log of workouts to identify strengths and weaknesses.



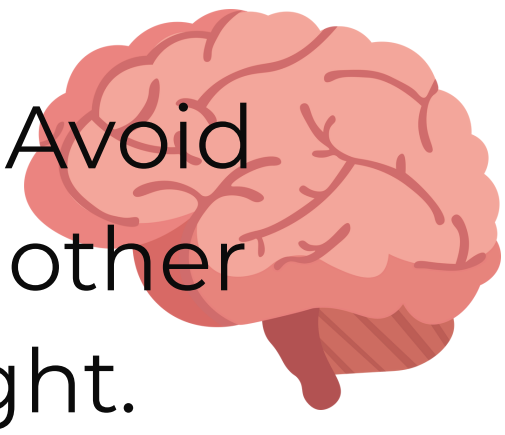
Tip: Choose a split that allows you to recover fully while staying consistent.

3. Mastering the Mind-Muscle Connection



Mind-muscle connection is key to maximizing hypertrophy. Here's how to improve it:

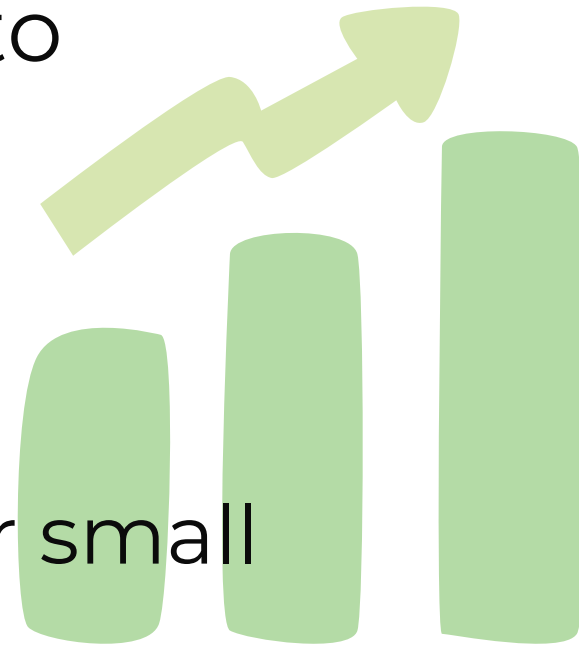
- **Slow Down Reps** – Control the weight, especially during the eccentric (lowering) phase.
- **Use Lighter Weights** – Focus on contraction rather than just lifting heavy.
- **Visualize & Feel the Muscle** – Before each set, take a second to think about the target muscle.
- **Use Isolation Exercises** – Exercises like bicep curls and leg extensions help enhance mind-muscle activation.
- **Reduce Momentum** – Avoid swinging or relying on other muscles to lift the weight.



4. Progression Strategies

To ensure consistent progress, use these strategies:

- **Linear Progression** – Increase weight or reps gradually each session.
- **Double Progression** – Increase reps first, then add weight.
- **Periodization** – Cycle intensity and volume to prevent plateaus and overtraining.
- **Progressive Range of Motion** – Improve flexibility and mobility to increase exercise effectiveness.
- **Strength Testing** – Test one-rep maxes (1RM) occasionally to assess improvements



Tip: Track your lifts and strive for small improvements weekly.

5. Muscle & Joint Health



Long-term progress depends on staying injury-free. Key factors include:

- **Warm-Up & Mobility** – 5-10 minutes of dynamic stretching before training.
- **Proper Form** – Always prioritize technique over heavy weights.
- **Rest & Recovery** – Schedule deload weeks to avoid burnout.
- **Hydration & Nutrition** – Joint health is improved with proper hydration and essential nutrients like omega-3s.
- **Soft Tissue Work** – Foam rolling and massage therapy can help with recovery.



Bonus: Incorporate mobility work and prehab exercises to keep joints healthy.

6. Common Mistakes & How to Fix Them

Avoid these pitfalls to optimize your training:

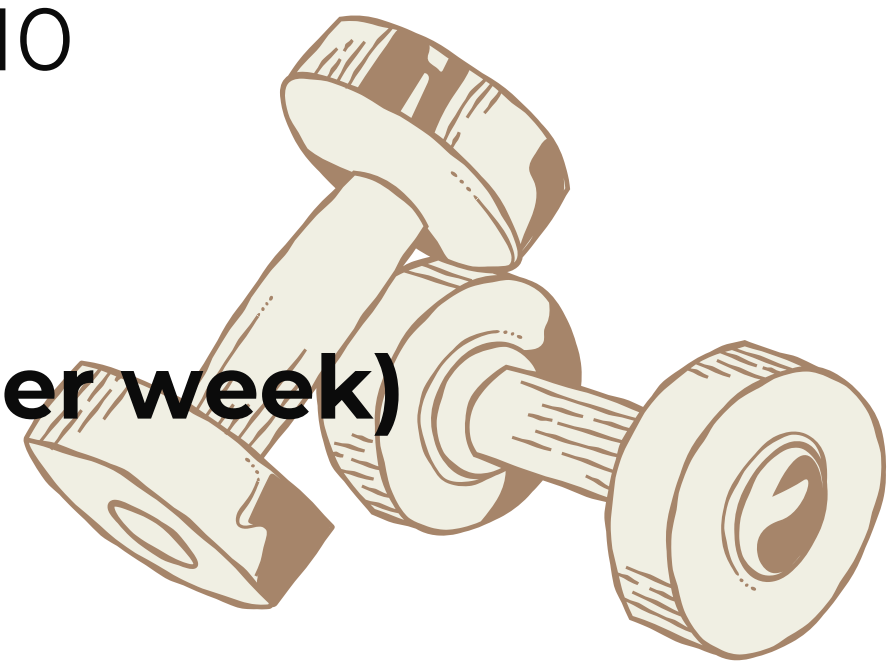
- **Not Training Hard Enough** – You should be close to failure in most sets.
- **Ignoring Recovery** – Rest and nutrition are as important as lifting.
- **Poor Exercise Selection** – Stick to compound movements and proven hypertrophy exercises.
- **Skipping Warm-Ups** – Not properly warming up increases injury risk.
- **Lack of Patience** – Results take time; consistency is key.

7. Sample Workout Plans

Here are some sample workouts for different training splits:

7.1 Full-Body (3x per week)

- Squats – 4x8
- Bench Press – 4x8
- Deadlifts – 3x6
- Pull-Ups – 3x8
- Shoulder Press – 3x10
- Core Work – 3 sets



7.2 Upper/Lower (4x per week)

Upper Body:

- Bench Press – 4x8
- Rows – 4x10
- Shoulder Press – 3x10
- Curls – 3x12
- Triceps Extensions – 3x12

Lower Body:

- Squats – 4x8
- Romanian Deadlifts – 3x10
- Lunges – 3x12
- Calf Raises – 3x15

7.3 Push/Pull/Legs (6x per week)

Push:

- Bench Press – 4x8
- Shoulder Press – 3x10
- Triceps Dips – 3x12

Pull:

- Deadlifts – 4x6
- Pull-Ups – 3x8
- Curls – 3x12

Legs:

- Squats – 4x8
- Lunges – 3x12
- Leg Press – 3x10



Conclusion

Strength and muscle growth take time, but with the right approach, consistency, and mindset, you'll see results. Train smart, recover well, and enjoy the journey to becoming stronger and more muscular. Always focus on quality training, nutrition, and recovery.

Wishing you all the best,
Fittest App Team!